



Railways to allot vacant land to install 500MW solar power plants

Railway Board chairman Vinod Kumar Yadav has said that Indian Railways will offer its vacant land for the installation of solar power plants amounting to a capacity of 500MW to meet its energy needs, reported the *Economic Times*.

Further, Indian Railways aims to install capacity for another 500MW of solar power and about 200MW from wind energy plants by 2021-22. This will be done across railway zones and production units.

The report said that the solar power plants will be installed on top of Railways' buildings through the public-private partnership (PPP) mode. The agreements will be for a period of 25 years.

As a pilot project for land-based power plants, a 3MW plant has already been installed at MCF, Raebareilly, Yadav was quoted as saying. He added that, in Bhilai, a 50MW plant on 300 acres of vacant railway land has been awarded

by Railway Energy Management Co. Ltd (REMCL). Work on this project is in progress with the commissioning targeted for March 2021.

Indian Railways has also taken up two pilot projects to feed solar power directly to a 25kV AC traction system. Diwana Solar Plant Project through REMCL is to be completed by March 2020, while Bina Solar Project through BHEL is targeted for completion by February 2020.

EESL inks MoU with HPCL to set up EV charging infrastructure

Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) has inked a two-year memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Hindustan Petroleum Corp. Ltd (HPCL) for setting up of public charging infrastructure as a part of National Electric Mobility Programme. Under the terms of the MoU, the two organisations will synergise business development to set up public charging infrastruc-

ture to boost electric mobility across India.

The MoU covers collaboration in planning, development and installation of charging infrastructure at suitable locations for two-, three- and four-wheelers. Sources from the two PSUs have said that installation of public charging stations will increase adoption of electric mobility. It will

also bring down automobile emissions, enabling a cleaner and greener environment.

Saurabh Kumar, managing director, EESL, said, "... our partnership with HPCL will also make charging infrastructure more visible, sending a signal to the general public that India's mobility vision is being realised to its full potential."

India's lack of electronics manufacturing ecosystem hurting ISRO's space plans

India's space agency had planned to build as well as launch seventeen home-grown satellites in 2019. It, however, managed to deliver only about half due to a shortage of electronics parts.

Absence of a robust home-grown electronics ecosystem is hurting the ambitious targets set by Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), which has lined up more than sixty missions over the next five years, according to an English daily. These include building new-generation communication and earth-observation satellites, heavier rockets, return missions to the moon and Mars, and its first human

space flight endeavour.

Each of these spacecraft and rockets needs reliable electronic components and systems. Over half of the electronics components on a large satellite and nearly a tenth for a rocket are imported as they need to meet stringent standards. These components should be reliable, radiation-hardened and work through the mission life of a satellite, which could be as many as fifteen years. The need therefore for such components is only going to increase as the space agency becomes more aggressive in pursuing cutting-edge missions.

ON THE move

Pitamber Shivnani joins GE T&D India as CEO and president

GE T&D India has announced appointment of Pitamber Shivnani as the company's chief executive officer and president, GE Grid Solutions South Asia. As part of this role, he will be responsible for managing GE's grid solutions markets for India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan and Myanmar from this region. Shivnani has an experience of over thirty years in the transmission and distribution sector in India. He joins GE T&D India from ABB where he was president of power grid division.